

Council Meeting
March 12, 2025
Page 1

The Claremont City Council held a meeting on Wednesday, March 12, 2025, in the Council Chambers of City Hall.

The meeting was called to order by Mayor Girard at 6:30 p.m.

Members of the Council present:

Ward I Councilor Andrew O’Hearne
Ward II Councilor Brian Zutter
Ward III Councilor Jonathan Hayden
Assistant Mayor Debora Matteau
At-Large Councilor William Greenrose
At-Large Councilor Wayne Hemingway
At-Large Councilor William Limoges
At-Large Councilor Nicholas Koloski
Mayor Dale Girard

Also present:

Yoshi Manale, City Manager

AGENDA CHANGES

None.

REPORT OF THE SECRETARY

A motion was made by Councilor Koloski and seconded by Councilor O’Hearne to accept the minutes of the February 26, 2025, City Council meeting.

Voice vote:

Koloski – yes

Greenrose – yes

Limoges - yes

Matteau – yes

Zutter – yes

Hemingway – yes

Hayden – yes

O’Hearne – yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 9-0

MAYOR’S NOTES

Stevens High School will be having their senior play “Clue” to be performed Friday March 28th, and Saturday March 29th.

CITY MANAGER’S REPORT

The CSBCC pool slide will be delivered on April 9th and expected to be installed the week of April 15th.

Barriers are to be removed on Sullivan Street with a temporary fix until the permeant install of pavers.

Projects that will be starting such as North and Main, and the excavation of the pickleball and tennis courts.

Pike Industries will be starting on Washington St. once the asphalt plants are open.

In February 2025 the City saw an increase of inspections and permits compared to last year.

Last Friday the City received keys for 17 Water Street and will start marketing next week.

Councilor Koloski asked for updates on the legal report regarding Planning Board procedure on social media, and the DES water meter generator. Councilor Koloski also asked about the Planning Department report chart initials CC and PM. Manager Manale will get this information.

Mayor Girard asked for better communication regarding the CSBCC pool being open or not, and if this will be a long-term issue.

Manager Manale noted the pool is about 11 years old and some pieces are failing but agreed the City needs to do better informing the public.

Mayor Girard asked for an update on the CSBCC equipment being compliant for ADA purposes, and stated it should have been set up like that in the first place when a company was hired to move it.

Manager Manale has a plan to have volunteers move the pieces.

Councilor Koloski asked for a full report on the pool.

APPOINTMENT TO BOARDS AND COMMITTEES

Claremont arts, history and culture resources preservation commission

A motion was made by Councilor Limoges and seconded by Assistant Mayor Matteau to appoint Josh Nelson to seat 5 on the Claremont arts, history and culture resources preservation commission.

Voice vote:

Koloski – yes

Greenrose – yes

Limoges - yes

Matteau – yes

Zutter – yes

Hemingway – yes

Hayden – yes

O’Hearne – yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 9-0

Conservation Commission

A motion was made by Assistant Mayor Matteau and seconded by Councilor Limoges to appoint Scott Magnuson to seat 4 of the Conservation Commission.

Voice vote:

Koloski – yes

Greenrose – yes

Limoges - yes

Matteau – yes

Zutter – yes

Hemingway – yes

Hayden – yes

O’Hearne – yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 9-0

Energy Advisory Committee

A motion was made by Assistant Mayor Matteau and seconded by Councilor O’Hearne to appoint Jack Paloucek to seat 1 on the Claremont Energy Advisory Committee.

Councilor Hemmingway invited Jack Paloucek to speak.

Jack Paloucek, Ward I, moved here last December, works at Eversource, and wants to lend some knowledge and stated he will recuse himself if voting on any Eversource matters.

Voice vote:

**Koloski – yes
Greenrose – yes
Limoges - yes
Matteau – yes
Zutter – yes
Hemingway – yes
Hayden – yes
O’Hearne – yes
Girard – yes
Motion carried 9-0**

HDC

A motion was made by Councilor Limoges and seconded by Councilor Greenrose to re-appoint David Messier to Seat 4 of the Historic District Committee.

**Voice vote:
Koloski – yes
Greenrose – yes
Limoges - yes
Matteau – yes
Zutter – yes
Hemingway – yes
Hayden – yes
O’Hearne – yes
Girard – yes
Motion carried 9-0**

A motion was made by Councilor Zutter and seconded by Councilor O’Hearne to re-appoint Tom Luther to Seat A-1 of the HDC.

**Voice vote:
Koloski – yes
Greenrose – yes
Limoges - yes
Matteau – yes
Zutter – yes
Hemingway – yes
Hayden – yes
O’Hearne – yes
Girard – yes
Motion carried 9-0**

Zoning Board of Adjustments

A motion was made by Councilor Limoges and seconded by Councilor Zutter to reappoint Michael Hurd to Seat 2 of the Zoning Board of Adjustment.

Voice vote:

Koloski – yes

Greenrose – yes

Limoges - yes

Matteau – yes

Zutter – yes

Hemingway – yes

Hayden – yes

O’Hearne – yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 9-0

A motion was made by Councilor Koloski and seconded by Councilor Greenrose to reappoint James Petrin to Seat 3 of the Zoning Board of Adjustments.

Voice vote:

Koloski – yes

Greenrose – yes

Limoges - yes

Matteau – yes

Zutter – yes

Hemingway – yes

Hayden – yes

O’Hearne – yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 9-0

A motion was made by Assistant Mayor Matteau and seconded by Councilor Greenrose to re-appoint Aran LaFontaine to Seat A-1 of the Zoning Board of Adjustments.

Voice vote:

Koloski – yes

Greenrose – yes

Limoges - yes

Matteau – yes

Zutter – yes

Hemingway – yes
Hayden – yes
O’Hearne – yes
Girard – yes
Motion carried 9-0

CITIZEN’S FORUM

Mayor Girard gave reminder that Citizen’s forum is designed to allow you the opportunity to make the Council aware of your concerns. Please state your name and ward number, we ask you to address your concerns directly to the Council. The Council Manager will not be responding to you during this time. You are limited to five minutes on any non-agenda items. In the back of the room please write down your contact information if you’d like to be contacted as well as your concern on the clipboard for follow-up.

Linda Gould Ward III, stated being happy about the install of tennis and pickleball courts, Ms. Gould was concerned about the courts not being separated and how it is hard to get a tennis court when there are also pickleball courts and would like the City to consider separating them.

Manager Manale noted there will be two tennis courts and four pickleball which are separate.

OLD BUSINESS

Resolution 2025-33 79-E Application 109 Pleasant St. – Public Hearing

The applicant was not able to attend.

A motion was made by Councilor O’Hearne and seconded by Assistant Mayor Matteau to accept resolution 2025-33 table to March 26th Meeting.

Roll Call:
Koloski – yes
Greenrose – yes
Limoges - yes
Matteau – yes
Zutter – yes
Hemingway – yes
Hayden – yes
O’Hearne – yes
Girard – yes
Motion carried 9-0

Resolution 2025-34 79-E Application 65 Pleasant St. – Public Hearing

City Planner Austin Ford introduced the 79-E application for 65 Pleasant Street to the Council.

The applicant and Council agreed the applicant would have until the end of the year for a start date and then fifteen months to complete the project. It was noted that if the applicant has all their permits they may start sooner, but the completion date remains the same.

A motion was made by Councilor Hemingway and seconded by Councilor Zutter to accept resolution 2025-34.

Councilor Hemingway read Resolution 2025-34 into the record.

Mayor Girard opened a public hearing, no one spoke, Mayor Girard closed the public hearing.

Councilor Hayden noted the number in the resolution is off and asked if it should be changed.

The Council agrees to change it to \$601,800.00 and all agree.

Councilor Koloski asked for another public hearing.

Mayor Girard opened a public hearing, no one spoke. Mayor Girard closed the public hearing.

Roll call:

Koloski – yes

Greenrose – yes

Limoges - yes

Matteau – yes

Zutter – yes

Hemingway – yes

Hayden – yes

O’Hearne – no

Girard – yes

Motion carried 8-1

Resolution 2025-35 79-E Application 16-26 Factory St. – Public Hearing

City Planner Ford also introduced the 79-E application for 16-26 Factory Street, and noted the Applicant is requesting five years of tax relief, after Council discussion the Council by consensus agreed on three years of tax relief.

A motion was made by Councilor Zutter and seconded by Assistant Mayor Matteau to accept resolution 2025-35.

Councilor Zutter read Resolution 2025-35 into the record.

Mayor Girard opened a public hearing, no one spoke. Mayor Giard closed the public hearing.

Roll call:

Koloski – yes

Greenrose – yes

Limoges - yes

Matteau – yes

Zutter – yes

Hemingway – yes

Hayden – yes

O’Hearne – no

Girard – yes

Motion carried 8-1

NEW BUSINESS

Road Surface Management System Presentation

City Planner, Ford and Director Gleeson presented a slide show on the the Road Surface Management System.

Memorandum

To: City Manager, Mayor and City Council

From: Austin Ford, City Planner

Date: March 5, 2025

Subject: Road Surface Management System Discussion

BACKGROUND

Between summer 2023 and spring 2024, regional planning staff at UVLSRPC, in collaboration with Claremont City staff, conducted a Road Surface Management System (RSMS) assessment of every municipally maintained paved road in Claremont. Roads were split into .25-mile segments, and each of the City’s over 400 segments was driven and assessed for the severity and extent of pavement distresses and other features of deterioration. UNH’s RSMS software was then used to complete the analysis.

DISCUSSION

This memorandum, the PowerPoint presentation, and the attached document will serve as the baseline for a comprehensive discussion about the process, results, and next steps. The City Manager, Mayor and City Council are encouraged to ask questions at any point during the discussion.

Supplementary Materials include:

- SADES RSMS PowerPoint Presentation
- UNH Technology Transfer Center's Guide to the RSMS Collection Standard

Resolution 2025-38 Overspend the Welfare Budget – Public Hearing

Director Carr, presented Resolution 2025-38 and noted across state the on-going housing crisis continues to affect local Welfare budgets and is requesting to overspend up to \$175,000.00.

A motion was made by Councilor Koloski and seconded by Councilor Zutter to Accept resolution 2025-38.

Mayor Girard opened a public hearing, no one spoke. Mayor Girard closed the public hearing.

Roll call:

Koloski – yes

Greenrose – yes

Limoges - yes

Matteau – yes

Zutter – yes

Hemingway – yes

Hayden – yes

O'Hearne – yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 9-0

Ordinance Discussion – Bicycles

Councilor Hemingway stated the Policy Committee reviewed the bicycles and mopeds ordinance.

Councilor Zutter clarified the definitions of bicycle, not including an e-bike as the e-bike statute from the state is being worked on but wanted to have something in place. Councilor Zutter also noted violations had been added and would be in accordance with the fee schedule.

The first offense is a \$50 fine, the second offense is a \$100 fine, and the third offense is a \$250 fine along with seizure of bike for 10 days.

Councilor Greenrose asked if all sidewalks are off limits, Councilor Limoges explained this exempts children with their parents.

Councilor Koloski stated there is a defined e-bike definition in an RSA and questioned if the City ordinance is current with state law.

Councilor Hayden shared concern for children riding to and from school without their parents and stated not being comfortable with forcing kids onto the street.

Assistant Mayor Matteau shared concern that the City currently has an ordinance on the books and doesn't want to adopt more regulations without enforcement. Assistant Mayor Matteau stated the current ordinance covers the City for what is needed.

Mayor Girard asked the Council if they wanted to come up with more thoughts and suggestions or hold off.

Assistant Mayor Matteau is in favor of leaving things the way they are.

By majority the consensus is to leave it the way it is.

2025 Identity Theft Program

Director Bates noted according to the City Charter this program has to be re-adopted each year.

A motion was made by Councilor O'Hearne and seconded by Assistant Mayor Matteau to re-adopt the Identity Theft Program.

Roll call:

Koloski – yes

Greenrose – yes

Limoges - yes

Matteau – yes

Zutter – yes

Hemingway – yes

Hayden – yes

O'Hearne – yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 9-0

Capital Reserve and Expendable Trust Fund Review and Cleanup Discussion

A motion was made by Councilor O’Hearne and seconded by Assistant Mayor Matteau to table Capital Reserve and Expendable Trust Fund Review and Cleanup Discussion.

Roll call:

Koloski – no

Greenrose – yes

Limoges - yes

Matteau – yes

Zutter – yes

Hemingway – yes

Hayden – no

O’Hearne – yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 7-2

Resolution 2025-40 Multi-Year Lease – City Hall Postage Meter and Folding Machine State Bid Pricing

Councilor Limoges asked if it would be cheaper to buy it rather than lease.
Director Bates stated no, and it will be replaced at the end of the lease.

A motion was made by Councilor Hayden and seconded by Assistant Mayor Matteau to accept Resolution 2025-40.

Councilor Hayden read Resolution 2025-40 into the record.

Mayor Girard opened a public hearing, no one spoke. Mayor Girard closed the public hearing.

Roll call:

Koloski – yes

Greenrose – yes

Limoges - yes

Matteau – yes

Zutter – yes

Hemingway – yes

Hayden – yes

O’Hearne – yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 9-0

Resolution 2025-41 Establishment of Capital Reserve for Parks and Recreation Vehicles and Equipment – Public Hearing

Director Bates explained Resolution 2025-41, and noted the finance office was tasked to create capital reserve funds for departments that don't have one, and is requesting to establish one to place the funds from the Parks and Recreation van auction.

A motion was made by Councilor Hemingway and seconded by Councilor O'Hearne to accept Resolution 2025-41.

Councilor Hemingway read Resolution 2025-41 into the record.

Mayor Girard opened a public hearing, no one spoke. Mayor Girard closed the public hearing.

Roll call:

Koloski – yes

Greenrose – yes

Limoges - yes

Matteau – yes

Zutter – yes

Hemingway – yes

Hayden – yes

O'Hearne – yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 9-0

Proposed Budget Hearing Schedule – Public Hearing

Mayor Girard opened a public hearing, no one spoke. Mayor Girard closed the public hearing.

The Council had no opposition to the hearing schedule.

Policy Committee Discussion

Mayor Girard noted concerns were brought to him several times, and questioned if the Policy Committee needed to meet on a regular basis or should they meet as needed.

Assistant Mayor Matteau stated the Policy Committee isn't efficient, and thinks Council should give directives.

A motion was made by Councilor Hemingway and seconded by Councilor O'Hearne to disband the Policy Committee.

Roll call:

Koloski – no

Greenrose – no

Limoges - yes

Matteau – no

Zutter - no

Hemingway - yes

Hayden – no

O’Hearne – yes

Girard – yes

Motion failed 4-5

A motion was made by Assistant Mayor Matteau and seconded by Councilor Greenrose to have the Policy Committee only meet as directed by the Council.

Roll call:

Koloski – yes

Greenrose – yes

Limoges - yes

Matteau – yes

Zutter – yes

Hemingway – no

Hayden – yes

O’Hearne – no

Girard – no

Motion carried 6-3

COMMITTEE REPORTS

Councilor Limoges reported the CDA looked at properties and damage repairs. Councilor Limoges also reported the Wall that Heals is going well, and the website is almost done, they have received lots of in-kind donations, and the art for the flyers was approved.

Assistant Mayor Matteau noted the Planning Board appointed Tom Luther to the Upper Valley Lake Sunapee Regional Planning Commission.

The ZBA discussed four variances and all were denied.

A motion was made by Councilor Hemingway and seconded by Assistant Mayor Matteau to appoint Councilor Greenrose to the Energy Committee.

Councilor Hayden noted the EPA had a Weston and Sampson presentation. And Manager Manale stated the presentation should be coming to Council in May.

FUTURE AGENDA ITEMS AND DIRECTIVES

Councilor Koloski would like a future item to be Class 6 roads building permits.

Assistant Mayor Matteau asked to send the procedure to legal.

A motion was made by Assistant Mayor Matteau and seconded by Councilor Koloski to send Class 6 Road Building Permits to legal.

Roll call:

Koloski – yes

Greenrose – yes

Limoges - yes

Matteau – yes

Zutter – yes

Hemingway – no

Hayden – yes

O’Hearne – no

Girard – no

Motion carried 6-3

Councilor Koloski shared concern about engaging the public during Citizen’s Forum.

Councilor Koloski asked for the Arts Committee Account to be established.

CONSULTATION WITH LEGAL COUNSEL

None.

ADJOURNMENT

At 9:46 p.m., a motion was made by Councilor Zutter and seconded by Councilor Hemingway to adjourn.

Voice vote:

Koloski – yes

Greenrose – yes

Limoges - yes

Matteau – opposed

Hemingway – yes

Zutter – yes

Hayden – yes

O’Hearne – opposed
Girard – yes
Motion carried 7-0, 2 opposed

Respectfully Submitted,

Julia A. Bizzarro
Clerk to the Council